

Mikhael E. Hayes

mikhael2@illinois.edu · mikhael2.github.io

Interests

Phonology, Poetic Rhyme, Subregular Computation, Basque, Language Change

Education

- 2023 – Present **University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign** – Urbana, IL
PhD in Linguistics (Expected May 2028), MA in Linguistics (May 2025)
Certificate in Romance Linguistics
GPA: 3.98
- 2019 – 2023 **Indiana University Bloomington** – Bloomington, IN
BA in Linguistics, BA in Hispanic Linguistics; Minor in Human-Centered Computing
GPA: 3.98

Writing

- Accepted April 2026 **Quantifying Aspiration in Zuberoan Basque**
With José Ignacio Hualde, for *Anuario del Seminario de Filología Vasca “Julio de Urquijo”* (ASJU).
- April 2026 **Raddoppiamento Sintattico in Logical Phonology**
Available on lingbuzz.
- In peer review **Computing Rhyme: A Tier-Based Strictly Local Approach to Poetic Rhyme as Harmony**
With Scott Nelson, for *Glossa*.
- In progress **Sounds, the same but different: A Tier-Based Strictly Local Unification of English Rhyme and Chinese Tonal Contrast in Poetry**

Presenting

- January 2026 **Poetic Rhyme as a Tier-Based Strictly Local Constraint**
Poster at the 2026 *Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting* (LSA), New Orleans (with Scott Nelson).
- November 2025 **Aspiration and its Historical Sources: Quantifying Aspiration in Zuberoan Basque**
Talk at the *First International Conference on the History of Basque* (ICHB1), University of the Basque Country.
- November 2025 **Computing Rhyme**
Talk at the 2025 *Rutgers Subregular Morphophonology Workshop*, Rutgers University.
- October 2025 **Aspiration and its Historical Sources: Quantifying Aspiration in Zuberoan Basque**
Poster at the 29th *Mid-Continental Phonetics and Phonology Conference* (MidPhon 29), Indiana University.

November 2024 **Tell it to me straight: Refusals in comparative pragmatics**
Talk at *Pragmatics and Language Learning* (PLL), Indiana University.

Research

- Fall 2026 **Research Centre for Basque Language and Texts** – Bayonne, France
Visiting researcher at IKER (CNRS UMR5478); experimentation on rhyme phonology in Basque oral poetry (*bertsolaritza*).
- August 2025 **Caucasian Languages in Georgia** – Zemo Alvani, Georgia
Student in the CauLaGe summer program; researching and documenting Tsova-Tush (Nakh-Daghestani); analysis of poetic rhyme.
- 2021 – 2023 **Pragmatics & Discourse at IU** – Bloomington, IN
Research assistant; audio processing, transcription, data entry for Spanish/English pragmatics research; copyediting; website maintenance.
- Summer 2021 **The Language Conservancy** – Bloomington, IN
Linguistics intern; revitalization work for Cowlitz Coast Salish (Ḷpúlmixq); lemma revision in Cowlitz-English bilingual dictionary.

Courses

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

- Spring 2026 **Instructor of Record, LING 210: Language History**
Lead lectures and discussions; design syllabus and materials; evaluate student progress.
- Spring 2026 **Teaching Assistant, LING 302: Elements of Phonology**
Lead review sessions and assist students in office hours.
- Fall 2025 **Instructor of Record, LING 210: Language History**
Lead lectures and discussions; design syllabus and course materials.
- Fall 2025 **Grader, LING 502: Phonology I**
Evaluate graduate-level assignments and provide feedback.
- Spring 2025 **Teaching Assistant, LING 225: Language, Mind, and Brain**
Lead discussion seminars in psycholinguistics.
- Fall 2024 **Teaching Assistant, LING 100: Intro to Language Science**
Facilitate discussion-based learning for introductory linguistics.
- Indiana University Bloomington*
- Summer 2022 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, SLST-S 135: Foundations of the American Experience**
Assist international students in acclimating to American academia (with Rex Sprouse).
- Fall 2021 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, LING-L 307: Phonology**
Facilitate learning of foundational phonology concepts; assist in office hours (with Stuart Davis).
- Fall 2020 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, LING-L 103: Intro to Linguistic Analysis**
Facilitate learning of fundamental linguistic concepts (with Ann Bunger).

Honors

Fall 2026	Chateaubriand Fellowship (Embassy of France in the United States)
2023 – Present	Community of Scholars Fellowship (UIUC)
2022 – Present	Phi Beta Kappa (ΦBK)
2021 – 2023	Sigma Delta Pi (ΣΔΠ) Spanish Honors Society, Vice-President (IU)
2019 – 2023	Adam W. Herbert Presidential Scholar (IU)
2019 – 2023	Founders Scholar for Sustained Academic Excellence (IU)
2019 – 2023	Executive Dean's List (IU)
2020 – 2023	Hispanic Scholarship Fund Scholar

Involvement

2026 – Present	Alphabetter: macOS IPA Input Utility, developer Develop a free macOS utility for International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA) input for linguists.
2026	The Vineyard Food Pantry at the Hope Center, weekly volunteer Pack and distribute food to those in need.
2024 – Present	Phonetics and Phonology Forum, and Historical Reading Group (UIUC), member Participate in academic reading groups and present own research.
2023 – Present	Twin City Bible Church, small group leader Lead academic and spiritual discussions of the Bible, coordinate practical service opportunities.
2019 – 2023	Honors Student Organization (IU), Vice President Coordinate events for the Hutton community; manage budgets and local business relations.
Spring 2022	Universidad Complutense de Madrid (UCM), student Study abroad for a semester in Madrid, Spain
2021 – 2022	Hutton Honors College Funding Board (IU), member Review student organization funding petitions.
Fall 2020	Feedback Assistant (IU) Provide linguistic feedback and speech improvement critiques for international teaching applicants (TEPAIC).

Skills

Technical Skills

Audio editing/transcription, copyediting, website maintenance, analytical research, $\LaTeX$, Git, Swift, Python, R.

Languages

English (native), Spanish (heritage/bilingual), Italian (limited), Basque (limited), French (limited).